it may not visit Europe, but as it appears to be marching towards Russia I have my fears.

We have had two English travellers here this year which is unusual. Mr Seymour[108] in the summer and now Mr Tasker, the former has gone back to England after visiting Georgia Persia Arabia Turkey etc. The latter has all his troubles before him, as he is just going to start to visit the antiquities of Kermanshan, perhaps the coldest part of Persia. He stands a chance in this hard weather of being blocked up in some village, and having to live in a cow house for some time if nothing worse happens to him. It is agreeable to see English faces and for some years back I have seen but few of them. Since the detachment of officers and serjeants left Persia in '39 we have seen very few Englishmen.

Tabreez, January 6, 1847

To day is the Greek and Russian X'mas day, but unfortunately the present Russian Consul General is a miserable fellow who shuts himself up in his house and will see no one, very unlike that good hearted jovial fellow M' d'Ozeroff who is now on leave in Russia, indeed he was only acting here during this ones absence his place being secretary of legation at Tehran. He however would like to get appointed here as the pay is better and it is an independent place.

Col Sheil goes home on leave in the spring and then Col Farrant[109] will be left in charge, the latter came out newly married last autumn. He had a most miserable journey, he was laid up dangerously ill at Constantinople, both he and his wife were ill at Erzeroom, and arriving here when cholera was ravaging the country, his favorite servant was carried off by that disease on the march.

I am much disappointed at having had no letters from you this month but hope to receive one by the courier who arrives in a day or two.

Tabreez, January 9, 1847

As our post from Tehran has been delayed some days and that from Europe has arrived a little before its usual time I have the pleasure of answering yours of the 5th Novr which arrived the day before yesterday. I have been much amused by the route it appears to have taken, for instead of coming direct by the Trebizonde steamers it has been travelling about Germany. You have directed it "Edwd Burgess Esquire Tabreez, to the care of James Brant Esquire Erzeroom." But underneath the word "Erzeroom" and close to it there is "Prussia." But I am not sure whether this is in your handwriting or not. It has however the Hamburg

108 Henry Danby Seymour, translator and editor of Ferrier's *Caravan journeys and wanderings in Persia.* No record can be found of the following traveler, Mr. Tasker.

109 Cf. note. 86.

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